



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brookings Classical Christian School

School Website: <https://brookings.k12.sd.us/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

School: Austin Classical School (Austin, TX) Website used: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Highlights: - Strong theological grounding and explicit transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty; Scripture central; chapel) consistent with the Six Elements framework. - Clear purpose: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; formation over mere information; the Great Conversation explicitly invoked. - Robust classical curriculum: trivium structure, Latin through middle school, logic and rhetoric (incl. thesis defense), great books, Bible and history sequences; explicit use of Socratic method. - Pedagogy matches classical patterns across grades: memorization/recitation/songs in grammar years; debate/discussion in logic; rhetoric, imitation, and thesis defense in upper school. - Parents are true partners ("co-teacher" model; collaborative schedule; chapel on tours; ongoing parent events). - ACCS accreditation announced Spring 2025, reinforcing classical Christian fidelity and accountability.

Note: Faculty language is generally positive (faith subscription; serve God; degreed professionals) but lacks an explicit "portrait of a teacher" or "faculty of friends/living curriculum" articulation on the public site; we score that category as Somewhat Classical (see Element 5).

Audit Framework Used

- Six Essential Elements of a Classical School: keyword indicators (positive/negative) and categorical expectations.
- Classicality lexicon (v2.2) mapped to six elements for keyword detection and scoring.

Scoring rubric: - For each category we: 1) Identify direct keywords/phrases from the school's site. 2) Compare to Six Elements positive/negative keyword indicators. 3) Quantify positive vs. negative hits and estimate coverage of sub-criteria. 4) Assign rating: CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL.

Element-by-Element Analysis

1) Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

- Evidence (site keywords/phrases):
- "exists to glorify Jesus Christ"; "classical, Christian education"
- "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty" as the aim/method of education
- "Scripture... at the center of the great conversation... we study those great books"
- Courses in Doctrine, Exegesis & Hermeneutics, Apologetics & Ethics (Christian Studies)
- All-School chapel (liturgical/communal practice)
- Statement of Faith for board, faculty, staff; all instruction rooted in these beliefs

- Keyword match to Six Elements (Positive):
- Transcendentals and moral realism: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom
- Grounded in theology: Scripture, doctrine, theology, Christian formation
- Liturgical/communal practices: chapel, communal worship rhythm
- Negative indicators: none observed (no “values-neutral,” “relativism,” etc.)
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: +12 (glorify Christ; TGB; Scripture/Bible; Christian Studies sequence; chapel; Statement of Faith; explicit theological language)
- Negative hits: -0
- percent_positive: 1.00
- percent_coverage: 1.00 (all three sub-criteria evidenced)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

2) School Purpose and Goal

- Evidence (site keywords/phrases):
- “To cultivate wisdom and virtue... through contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”
- “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation and more about learning to think and live with an eternal purpose”
- Educating the “whole person”—mind, body, soul
- Keyword match to Six Elements (Positive):
- Cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation (not mere information)
- Negative indicators: none observed (no “college and career readiness” emphasis or similar language)
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: +8
- Negative hits: -0
- percent_positive: 1.00
- percent_coverage: 1.00 (all three purposes addressed)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

3) Curriculum

- Evidence (site keywords/phrases):
- Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric); Latin from grade 5; logic in 8th; rhetoric in 10th; thesis defense in senior year
- “we employ the Socratic method” (method supporting curriculum)
- Great Books; Bible central to the Great Conversation; explicit history/literature sequences (Ancient, Medieval, Modern, American)
- “subjects will be integrated... humanities... integration of history, reading, writing, and art... to discover Truth, Goodness, and Beauty”

- Keyword match to Six Elements (Positive):
- Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium stated explicitly; Quadrivium arts present via math/music though not labeled)
- Great Books and historical engagement; primary texts; classical canon
- Integrated approach; unity of knowledge; harmony of subjects; “Great Conversation”
- Integration/wonder aims (curiosity, beauty, integrated curriculum)
- Negative indicators: none observed (uses “History,” not “Social Studies”; no project-based/skills-first dominance)
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: +16
- Negative hits: -0
- percent_positive: 1.00
- percent_coverage: 0.92 (Trivium/Great Books/Integration strong; Quadrivium is implied via music/-math but not explicitly enumerated)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

4) Pedagogy (Teaching Methods)

- Evidence (site keywords/phrases):
- Grammar years: “memorization, recitation, and songs”
- Logic years: students learn by “debate and discussion”
- Upper school: “Socratic method,” “rhetoric,” “imitation,” “thesis defense”
- Keyword match to Six Elements (Positive):
- Socratic dialogue/dialectic; debate; discussion; rhetoric; imitation; memorization/recitation/singing
- Negative indicators: none observed (no constructivist or project-based dominance)
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: +8
- Negative hits: -0
- percent_positive: 1.00
- percent_coverage: 0.83 (clear memory work and Socratic/rhetoric; restful learning/scholé not explicitly named on site pages sampled)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

5) Faculty

- Evidence (site keywords/phrases):
- “Head of School who loves Jesus... teachers... serving God by teaching students about His world using the classical approach”
- “degreed professionals” who “fully and joyfully subscribe to our Statement of Faith”
- Keyword match to Six Elements (Positive):

- Teachers as models of virtue/faith commitment; classical formation indicators present but not elaborated as a formal “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum”
- Negative indicators: none (no “facilitators/guide on the side” jargon; no certification-first rhetoric)
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: +4
- Negative hits: -0
- percent_positive: 1.00
- percent_coverage: 0.50 (faith commitment and purpose evident; lacking explicit “portrait of teacher,” collegial “faculty of friends,” teacher-as-mentor language on public pages)
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Notes to improve: Publish an explicit “Portrait of a Teacher,” emphasize faculty mentoring and collegial formation (e.g., Great Books seminars for faculty; “faculty of friends”), and describe teacher development in classical pedagogy (all align with Six Elements positives).

6) Parents and Community

- Evidence (site keywords/phrases):
- Mission: “co-laboring with families” to cultivate wise and virtuous students
- Collaborative schedule with at-home “co-teacher parent”; teacher office hours on homeschool days; explicit benefits to family time and formation
- Parents welcomed for chapel on tours; ongoing prospective parent events and campus visits
- Vibrant upper school community (house system)
- Keyword match to Six Elements (Positive):
- Partnership with families; parent formation/engagement; hospitable school community rhythms
- Negative indicators: none (no “parent as customer” language)
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: +7
- Negative hits: -0
- percent_positive: 1.00
- percent_coverage: 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Rating

- Categories: [1] CLASSICAL, [2] CLASSICAL, [3] CLASSICAL, [4] CLASSICAL, [5] SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, [6] CLASSICAL
- Overall: CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school’s public materials align tightly with the Six Elements—rich theological foundations (Scripture central; chapel), a purpose centered on wisdom/virtue and the transcendentals, an integrated trivium-based curriculum (Latin, logic, rhetoric, great books; Socratic method), and a strong partnership-with-parents model. Faculty language is generally sound but could be made more explicitly classical with

a publicly articulated teacher portrait and formation model. The school's 2025 ACCS accreditation further corroborates classical Christian fidelity and quality control.

Detailed Keyword Tally (selected)

- Religious/metaphysical: "glorify Jesus Christ," "Truth, Goodness, and Beauty," "Scripture," "chapel," "Statement of Faith," "Apologetics & Ethics"
- Purpose/goal: "cultivate wisdom and virtue," "eternal purpose," "Great Conversation," "whole person"
- Curriculum: "Trivium," "Latin," "Logic," "Rhetoric," "Great Books," "Socratic method," "thesis defense," "History" (not "Social Studies")
- Pedagogy: "memorization, recitation, songs," "debate and discussion," "Socratic," "imitation," "thesis defense"
- Faculty: Statement-of-faith subscription; "serve God"; degreed teachers
- Parents/community: "co-laboring with families," "co-teacher parent," chapel on tours; parent events; house system

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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